

# MELODIC IMPROVISATION (PART 1)

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #64

Here are five great, easy to understand ways to embellish a melody, which will eventually lead us to improvising in a melodic fashion.

- 1) Add syncopations, especially playing an “on beat” an 8th note early. For instance, if the target note is written on beat 3, play it on the “+ of 2” instead, an 8th note early.
- 2) Repeat some melody notes. Just re-articulate a note one or more times.
- 3) Add Upper Neighbor Tones. Usually diatonic notes (in the key of the song) will sound best to our ears.
- 4) Add Lower Neighbor Tones. Usually notes down a 1/2 step sound best to our ears.
- 5) Add Passing Notes. These are notes that fill in the space between two of the written notes of the melody. If a C and an D are written, C# would be a passing note.

## When The Saints Go Marching In - "stock melody"



## When The Saints Go Marching In - "embellished melody"

